ZAKHEERA AI SOLUTIONS (PRIVATE) LIMITED

Travel and Expense Reimbursement Policy

Travel approval, limits, per diem and claims

Policy ID	ZAI-HR-TE-008
Version	2.0
Effective date	1 January 2024
Policy owner	Finance and Human Resources
Applies to	All employees travelling on Company business
Approved by	Chief Executive Officer and Head of Human Resources
HR contact	hr@zakheera.ai | Extension 2200 | HR Helpdesk on the ZakheeraHR portal

1. Purpose and Principles

This policy governs business travel and the reimbursement of reasonable, necessary and documented expenses. Employees should spend Company money as carefully as their own. Personal expenses are never reimbursed.

2. Approvals

- All overnight and international travel needs prior approval in ZakheeraHR (Travel Request) from the manager and Department Head. International travel also needs Finance approval.
- Request domestic travel at least 5 working days ahead and international travel at least 15 working days ahead to secure better fares and visas.
- Travel without approval may not be reimbursed.
- Travel is allowed only when a call cannot achieve the same outcome.

3. Transport

Mode	Rule
Domestic flights	Economy class, booked through the Admin travel desk. Business class is not allowed
International flights	Economy for flights under 6 hours. Premium economy or business for flights over 6 hours only for G6 and above with CEO approval
Intercity bus or train	Executive or business class bus/train allowed when cheaper than flights
Local transport	Ride-hailing (Careem or Bykea style services) or a taxi for client meetings and airport transfers, with receipts. Rickshaw fares up to PKR 1,000 without a receipt
Personal vehicle	PKR 45 per kilometre for car and PKR 18 per kilometre for motorcycle for approved business trips, with a trip log
Car rental	Only with Department Head approval, for trips where other options are unavailable

4. Accommodation

Location	G1 to G4 (per night)	G5 and above (per night)
Karachi, Lahore, Islamabad	PKR 18,000	PKR 28,000
Other Pakistani cities	PKR 12,000	PKR 20,000
International (Gulf region)	USD 150	USD 220
International (rest of world)	USD 180	USD 260

Limits include taxes. Stays above the limit need prior approval. Hotels should be booked through the Admin travel desk, and guest houses may be used when cheaper. Personal items from the hotel (minibar, spa, laundry for stays of less than 3 nights, entertainment) are not reimbursed.

5. Meals and Daily Allowance (Per Diem)

Destination	G1 to G4	G5 and above	Covers
Domestic (overnight)	PKR 6,000 per day	PKR 8,000 per day	Meals, tips, local incidentals
International, Gulf region	USD 60 per day	USD 80 per day	Same
International, other	USD 75 per day	USD 100 per day	Same

Per diem is paid without receipts on days away from the home city. If the host or client provides meals at no cost, the per diem is reduced by 10% for breakfast, 30% for lunch and 30% for dinner. On travel days of less than 6 hours, half the per diem is paid. A day trip without overnight stay receives PKR 2,000 for meals.

6. Advances

Employees may request a travel advance of up to 80% of the estimated costs, 5 working days before departure, through ZakheeraHR. Advances must be settled within 15 days of return. Unsettled advances are recovered from salary.

7. Claiming Expenses

- Submit the expense report in ZakheeraHR within **15 days** of returning from the trip or incurring the expense. Claims older than 45 days are not reimbursed.
- Attach receipts or invoices for every expense of PKR 1,000 or more. Items below PKR 1,000 need a short description.
- Claims must show date, purpose, project or cost centre and amount. Foreign currency claims are converted at the rate on the date of spending, with card statement or bank rate evidence.
- Managers approve within 3 working days. Finance reviews and pays in the next payroll cycle, or by bank transfer within 10 working days if the claim is received after the 20th.
- False or inflated claims are gross misconduct.

8. Other Reimbursable Business Expenses

Expense	Rule
Client entertainment	Pre-approved by Department Head, up to PKR 5,000 per person. Attendee names and business purpose required
Mobile and internet while travelling	Roaming or local SIM packages up to PKR 5,000 per domestic trip and PKR 10,000 per international trip
Visa, travel insurance and vaccinations	Fully reimbursed for approved international business travel

Expense	Rule
Conference and training registration	Reimbursed with prior approval from the Department Head
Laundry	Only for trips of 5 nights or more, up to PKR 2,000

9. Not Reimbursable

- Fines, penalties, parking violations and traffic challans.
- Alcohol, tobacco and personal entertainment.
- Travel of family members or personal side trips and extended stays for personal reasons.
- Lost personal belongings and upgrade costs without approval.
- Expenses without receipts above the PKR 1,000 limit.

10. Safety and Emergencies

Employees should share itinerary with their manager. Travelling to areas under government advisories requires CEO approval. In emergencies, contact the 24-hour Admin travel desk at travel@zakheera.ai or Extension 2450. Business travel accident insurance of PKR 5,000,000 applies. Travel medical insurance is arranged for international trips.

11. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: What is the deadline to submit travel expenses?
A: Within 15 days of the return from the trip. Claims older than 45 days are not reimbursed.

Q: Do I need receipts for everything?
A: Receipts are needed for each expense of PKR 1,000 or more. Per diem is paid without receipts.

Q: What is the domestic per diem?
A: PKR 6,000 per day for G1 to G4 and PKR 8,000 for G5 and above.

Q: What is the hotel limit in Karachi?
A: PKR 18,000 per night for G1 to G4 and PKR 28,000 for G5 and above.

Q: Can I fly business class?
A: Not for domestic travel. For international flights over 6 hours, only G6 and above with CEO approval.

Q: How much is mileage reimbursed?
A: PKR 45 per kilometre for a car and PKR 18 per kilometre for a motorcycle, with a trip log.

Q: When will I be paid back?
A: In the next payroll cycle after approval, or within 10 working days by bank transfer for late claims.

Q: Can I get an advance?
A: Yes, up to 80% of the estimated costs, requested 5 working days before departure. Settle within 15 days of return.